



COAL



Like layers of icing in a cake, there are bands, or seams, of coal in the rocks beneath the ground. Some seams are near enough to the surface to be scraped out with diggers. This

is called opencast mining. But most seams are found deeper down, and have to be dug up by miners using massive machines. About 40 percent of the nine billion tons of coal mined each year is burned in power stations to generate electricity.

Cooking coke

Coal is put into giant ovens and baked at more than 1,650°F (900°C). When the oven door is opened, coke topples out. Coke is needed to make steel.



Coke is coal minus tar, oils, and gases.



The tar that collects at the bottom of a coke oven is used to make soap!

